WORD LADDERS

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Each ladder starts with the word in the gray box. Change one sound at a time to climb it, using the clue beside each step. Every word on every ladder has a glued sound.

LADDER 1

sing	Start here. Read it out loud.
	Add t after the s: what a bee does
	Add r: you tie a parcel with it
	Change the vowel to o: not weak
	Change the vowel to u: beads on a thread are ___

LADDER 2

sink	Start here. Read it out loud.
	Change the vowel to a: the old boat ___
	Change k to g: she ___ a song
	Change s to r: the bell ___
	Change the vowel to i: you wear it on a finger

LADDER 3

bunk	Start here. Read it out loud.
	Change u to a: money is kept here
	Add l: empty, with nothing written on it
	Change b to p: a long flat board of wood
	Take the k off: what you make before a trip

LADDER 4

can	Start here. Read it out loud.
	Add l: a big family group
	Change n to m: a sea animal in a shell
	Change c to s: to shut a door hard
	Add g at the end: everyday words, not formal ones

Say both words out loud at every step and name what changed. On ladder 2 the chunk changes as you climb: ink, ank, ang, ang, ing. That is the whole point of the glued sounds, because one small change at the end turns sank into sang.

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WORD LADDERS ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... Date: .....

Each ladder starts with the word in the gray box. Change one sound at a time to climb it, using the clue beside each step. Every word on every ladder has a glued sound.

LADDER 1

sing	Start here. Read it out loud.
sting	Add t after the s: what a bee does
string	Add r: you tie a parcel with it
strong	Change the vowel to o: not weak
strung	Change the vowel to u: beads on a thread are ___

LADDER 2

sink	Start here. Read it out loud.
sank	Change the vowel to a: the old boat ___
sang	Change k to g: she ___ a song
rang	Change s to r: the bell ___
ring	Change the vowel to i: you wear it on a finger

LADDER 3

bunk	Start here. Read it out loud.
bank	Change u to a: money is kept here
blank	Add l: empty, with nothing written on it
plank	Change b to p: a long flat board of wood
plan	Take the k off: what you make before a trip

LADDER 4

can	Start here. Read it out loud.
clan	Add l: a big family group
clam	Change n to m: a sea animal in a shell
slam	Change c to s: to shut a door hard
slang	Add g at the end: everyday words, not formal ones

Say both words out loud at every step and name what changed. On ladder 2 the chunk changes as you climb: ink, ank, ang, ang, ing. That is the whole point of the glued sounds, because one small change at the end turns sank into sang.

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